

MATTHEW O'LEARY

Print Production Lead | Magazines, Catalogs & Publishing

Santa Cruz, CA | 831-275-2566 | matt@mattoleary.design

mattoleary.design | linkedin.com/in/matt-oleary

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Print production leader with 20+ years of experience managing magazines, 800+ page national retail catalogs, books, and consumer packaging. Combine advanced, hands-on InDesign expertise with end-to-end production management, from schedules and preflight through proof approval and printer coordination.

Currently serve as Designer & Production Manager for California magazine (Cal Alumni Association), managing production from layout through press with Quad. Build templates, file standards, and automated workflows that keep complex publications consistent and press-ready.

CORE SKILLS

- Production management: End-to-end production ownership; schedules and page flow; editorial, design, and photo coordination; approval cycles; release readiness; post-press archiving.
- Prepress and print quality: PDF/X preflight; Acrobat Pro; CMYK and spot/Pantone color; image correction; color separations; pagination; imposition; proofing and press checks.
- InDesign systems and automation: Templates; parent pages; paragraph and character styles; naming conventions; GREP styles; Find/Change queries; Data Merge; JavaScript/ExtendScript; export and delivery standards.
- Publishing and packaging: Magazines; alumni and custom publications; national retail catalogs; book interiors and covers; multilingual curriculum; accessible PDFs; packaging mechanicals and product labels.
- Printer and vendor coordination: File delivery; proof approval; materials and specifications; quality control; seasonal and multi-SKU releases; offset, digital, screen printing, and large-format production.
- Software: Adobe InDesign, Illustrator, Photoshop, Acrobat Pro, Firefly and Generative Fill; Jira, Trello, Airtable; Figma; Microsoft Office; ChatGPT, Claude, Midjourney.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Designer & Production Manager | California Magazine (Cal Alumni Association)

Aug 2026 - Present | Remote, Contract

- Own magazine production from layout through press, coordinating page flow, ad preflight, image placement, and final files for editorial pages, advertising, and custom inserts.
- Manage the printer relationship with Quad, overseeing file delivery, proof approval, and press coordination to meet a fixed publication schedule.

- Coordinate layout and proof reviews with the Creative Director and Managing Editor, managing revisions and approvals under deadline.
- Built the Fall 2026 issue's class notes, obituaries, and masthead sections from scratch, applying consistent typography and styles across dense, repetitive content.
- Prepare post-press file packages and web and promotional assets using template-based and AI-assisted workflows.

Production Consultant & Designer | Matt O'Leary Design

2010 – Present | Santa Cruz, CA

- Manage production for packaging, publishing, and branded-collateral clients from initial brief through final delivery.
- Develop FDA-compliant packaging mechanicals and product labels, preparing artwork for print production.
- Create screen-printing color separations from a wide range of source artwork for clients including O'Neill Surf Shop.
- Build paneled and tiled large-format files for trade-show booths, building drapes, and bus wraps.
- Coordinate print and fabrication vendors on materials, proofs, quality control, and delivery; track schedules and approvals in Trello.

Production Support Specialist | OBXtek (Defense Language Institute contract)

Dec 2024 – Oct 2025 | Monterey, CA

- Produced and maintained complex, long-form foreign-language curriculum in InDesign, following established templates, styles, and formatting standards.
- Standardized templates and visual assets across 14+ language pipelines to support consistent production.
- Coordinated deliverables, versions, and deadlines in Airtable.
- Performed production quality control and prepared accessible PDFs, applying accessibility standards to government curriculum.

Senior Designer | Wiser Solutions, Axway, Kiteworks

2014 – 2023 | Remote and Palo Alto, CA

- Axway (2018–2022): Built template-driven systems for global print and digital marketing campaigns, improving consistency and delivery speed across distributed teams.
- Wiser Solutions (2022–2023) and Kiteworks (2014–2018): Maintained design-system and standardized asset handoffs between remote design and engineering teams.

Creative Lead | FastPencil

Oct 2011 – May 2014 | Campbell, CA

- Led typographic design and production for 50+ book interiors and covers annually using InDesign and Illustrator.

- Built complete book templates defining typography, page structure, and style hierarchies for full-length publications.
- Prepared final files for commercial printers, KDP, and IngramSpark, achieving a high rate of first-pass acceptance.

Print Production Manager | McDill Associates

Sep 2008 – Nov 2011 | Soquel, CA

- Managed print production workflows and designed packaging for national retail brands including Costco, Martinelli's, and Rainbow Light.
- Built and verified dielines, spot-color separations, and regulated copy for multi-SKU packaging programs.
- Coordinated printers and paper suppliers to support on-time product rollouts.
- Produced wayfinding, large-format signage, and brand-activation materials for trade shows including PMA.

Prepress Manager | West Marine

Jan 2002 – Aug 2008 | Watsonville, CA

- Managed prepress for 800+ page national retail catalogs, overseeing preflight, color management, pagination, imposition, and proofing.
- Coordinated high-volume seasonal production with print vendors, managing schedules, quality requirements, and specifications.
- Conducted press checks at Midwest printers to verify print quality and production requirements.

Co-founder | The Juice Surf Magazine

1994 – 2000 | Santa Cruz, CA

- Co-founded and ran an independent quarterly surf magazine for approximately six years.
- Produced roughly 20 issues, managing the publication from editorial through print production.

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz
Coursework in Art, Design & Visual Studies